

Chapter 11 _ Scalling AI Agents

20/80 Practice

This practice identifies the 20% of activities consuming 80% of people's time.

- Information gathering and consolidation from multiple systems
- Initial claims triage and routing
- Standard correspondence with customer and services
 - All of these activities were not just time consuming but they are also described as tedious, repetitive, and prone to errors.

Feasibility assessment

AI opportunity against 3 key area:

- **Technical feasibility:** Could current AI agent technology handle task effectively?
- **Process stability:** Was the process stable enough to automatet, or did it require significant redesign?
- **Data availability:** Did we have access to the necessary data in a usable format?

Systemic path to scale

Phase 1: Process redesign and Optimization

We have to reimagine the process and ask ourselves: "If we were building this today with AI agents, how would it work?"

The redesign process consolidated access points, standardized data format, and create handoffs between AI agents and human adjuster.

Phase 2: Deployment Sprint

Organizing the work into fragment (3 weeks, or 4 weeks...)

Each sprint focuses on the delivering specific functionality that could be tested and refined. We involved claim adjuster in every sprint review, gathering their feedback and making adjustments.

Phase 3: Testing and production migration

Instead of big approach, we implemented a graduated deployment strategy:

- Week 1: 10% of incoming claims routed through the AI agent
- Week 2: 25% of claims, with expanded monitoring
- Week 3: 50% of claims, with reduced manual oversight

- Week 4: 75% of claims, maintaining audit protocols
- Week 5: Full deployment with standard monitoring

Level 2: Automation Intelligence

- This level combines RPA, Business process manager (BPM), and various AI tools
- Good for repetitive task, rule-based tasks within clearly defined parameter.

but the level 3 agents can understand the context, process natural language, and orchestrate multiple tools to achieve broader objective.

Key considerations for organization

- **Start with clear use cases:** this focused approach helps manage complexity and demonstrate value
- **Build on strengths:** Whether those strengths come from previous automation experiences or other organizational capabilities, identify and leverage existing advantages rather than starting completely fresh.
- **Manage expectations:** the jump from agent level 2 to 3 is not just a technical upgrade but it represents a fundamental shift in how work gets done. Organizations need to prepare for both the opportunities and challenges this present.

Organization must define clear goals, ensure data integrity, and design agents that integrate seamlessly into existing workflows to achieve their full transformation potential.

Building a transformative framework

1. **Start with Gen AI:** Encourage the employees to experiment with Gen AI tools in their daily tasks. Provide training, incentivize adoption, and create forums for sharing best practice.
2. **Scale with AI agents:** AI agents for repetitive task and complex process. Start with pilot project to refine the implementation and gradually scale across departments. Involve employee in designing agents that complement their workflows, fostering a sense of ownership.
3. **Foster a culture of learning and adaptation:** Invest in continuous education to help employees integrate AI into their roles. Highlight success stories and encourage teams to experiment, learn, and innovate
4. **Align Metrics with strategic goals:** Define KPIs that measure both efficiency gains and human-centric outcomes such as employee satisfaction, creativity, and collaboration. Regularly review these metrics to ensure the transformation stays aligned with organizational objective.
5. **Prioritize Governance and Ethics:** Establishing governance structure that ensure ethical AI use, data privacy, and transparency. Create forum for the employee to voice their concerns and participate in shaping the transformation journey.

Good Agents go bad

Sometime, they can operate independently in ways that their creators did not anticipate and can not easily control.

The new frontier of risk

- Modern AI can interpret and act on high-level, often vague goals.
- They can interact with the world in unprecedented ways.
- These agents can operate indefinitely without direct supervision.

So the challenge ahead is not about controlling individual agents, but it is all about understanding and managing these ecosystem.